Overview: IELTS Band Score Calculation

Alright, so you're aiming to ace the IELTS—great! But how do you even get a score? And what does that score mean?

The **IELTS test** is divided into **four parts**:

1. **Listening**
2. **Reading**
3. **Writing**
4. **Speaking**

Each part is scored **individually out of 9 bands**, and the **final score** is the **average of the four**.

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1. Listening Section Scoring

- There are **40 questions**.
- Each correct answer = **1 mark**.
- Your **raw score** out of 40 is converted into a **band score**.

✅ **Example Conversion Table:**

Correct Answers	Band Score
39-40	9.0
37-38	8.5
35-36	8.0
30-31	7.0
23-26	6.0

So if you get **32/40**, your Listening Band Score would be **7.5**.

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2. Reading Section Scoring

- Also has **40 questions**.
- 1 mark per correct answer.
- The band conversion varies slightly between **Academic** and **General Training** modules.

✅ **Academic Reading Band Example:**

Correct Answers	Band Score
39-40	9.0
34-35	7.5
30-32	7.0
23-26	6.0

So if you get **28 correct**, that might be **6.5 Band** (depending on the test difficulty).

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3. Writing Section Scoring

Writing is scored on **four criteria**, each graded from **0 to 9**:

1. **Task Achievement** (Task 1) / **Task Response** (Task 2)
2. **Coherence and Cohesion**
3. **Lexical Resource** (Vocabulary)
4. **Grammatical Range and Accuracy**

✅ **Example:**

Criteria	Band
Task Response	6
Coherence and Cohesion	7
Lexical Resource	7
Grammar	6

Total = (6 + 7 + 7 + 6) ÷ 4 = 6.5 Band

👉 *Note:* Task 2 has more weight, but both are important.

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4. Speaking Section Scoring

Speaking is also marked on **four criteria**, from **0 to 9**:

1. How smoothly you speak (fluency)
2. Your word choice (vocabulary)
3. Grammar
4. Pronunciation

✅ **Example:**

Criteria	**Band**
Fluency and Coherence	7
Vocabulary	6.5
Grammar	6
Pronunciation	6.5

Total = (7 + 6.5 + 6 + 6.5) ÷ 4 = 6.5 Band

Think of it as a 10–15-minute chat. Be natural and confident!

How the Final Score Is Calculated

Let's say your scores are:

- Listening: **8.0**
- Reading: **7.0**
- Writing: **6.5**
- Speaking: **6.0**

You add them up:
8.0 + 7.0 + 6.5 + 6.0 = **27.5**
Then divide by 4 → **6.875**

Final Band = 7.0 (It gets rounded UP!)

Final Rounding Rules:

- If the average ends in **.25**, it's rounded **up to the next half band**
  → *6.25 becomes 6.5*
- If the average ends in **.75**, it's rounded **up to the next whole band**
  → *6.75 becomes 7.0*
- If it ends in **.1, .2, .3, .4** → Rounded **down to nearest half**
  → *6.3 becomes 6.0*

Note:

Balance is key. If one section feels weaker, you can make up for it in another.
Practice smart, not just hard!